ought to be. He classified constitutions as Aristocracy, Timocracy, Oligarchy, Democracy and Tyranny. He also said that there is a tendency of Aristocracy to degenerate into Timocracy, Timocracy into Oligarchy, Oligarchy into Democracy and Democracy into Tyranny.

Bringing up of Children

According to ***Plato***, children were national possession and as such it was obligatory on the part of the State to bring them up according to their attitudes.

Plato's dialectical Method

Plato used this method in his book 'The Republic'. He writes this book as if he is asking questions as a student and ***Socrates*** is answering as his teacher. Unlike 'Didactics' i.e. a teacher authoritatively teaches a subject because the teacher knows it and the students don't, 'Dialectics' is a question and answer type of method where the student has a vague idea about something and throws questions to the teacher about it and the teacher's answers are again questioned. By this the teacher facilitates the student to formulate and reformulate his idea in order to arrive at the best possible understanding of the idea.

Assessment

Plato, though by no means the first philosopher, undoubtedly is one of the earliest to leave us a significant body of work. He spent most of his time asking and providing answers to questions that have always troubled people. Even centuries after his death, ***Plato*** is considered the most influential political philosopher of all times.

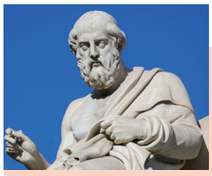
7.2 Aristotle

(384 – 322 BCE)



Learning Objectives

- To understand the Political thought of ***Aristotle***.
- This will help to compare thinkers on similar concept
- To gain knowledge about ***Aristotle*** ideas on Ideal State, Citizenship, normal and perverted forms of constitution and Monarchy, forms of *government and democracy*



Man is by nature a political animal and he, who by nature and not by mere accident is without state is either above humanity or below it.

-*Aristotle* in his book Politics

Life and Times

William Ebenstien says" In the history of political philosophy no one has surpassed ***Aristotle*** in encyclopaedic interest and accomplishment".

Aristotle was ***Plato***'s student at his 'Academy'. After ***Plato***'s death, ***Aristotle*** found his own school called 'The Lyceum'

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